Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C. Frequently Asked Questions

Purpose

In accordance with sections 282.0051(1)(c–d) and (m), Florida Statute (F.S.), the Florida Digital Service (FLDS) is responsible for establishing project management and oversight standards, performing project management oversight, and reporting on high-risk State and Cabinet agency Information Technology (IT) Projects. Section (s.) 282.0051(6), F.S. establishes FLDS' rulemaking authority.

This Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) document is intended to provide clear and consistent guidance to common questions asked by State and Cabinet Agencies (collectively, "Enterprise Agencies") regarding the requirements established in Rule Chapter 60GG-1, Florida Administrative Code (F.A.C.).

Rule

1. What types of IT Projects are excluded from Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C. requirements?

Projects that do not meet the statutory definitions of both "Information Technology" and "Project" under s. 282.0041, F.S., are not subject to Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C.

All IT Projects that meet those statutory definitions are subject to the requirements of the rule. Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C., establishes a Risk-based approach to project governance based on the nature, size, and Risk of the project.

Information Technology Projects that also meet the definition of an Operations and Maintenance (O&M) activity are subject only to the requirements of Rule 60GG-1.002(6), F.A.C., provided they satisfy all of the following criteria:

- The Total Project Cost is less than $500,000;
- The total estimated effort is less than 320 hours; and
- The project is expected to be completed in less than 60 days.

O&M projects that exceed any of the thresholds above must comply with the requirements of Rule 60GG-1.002(2) through (5), F.A.C.

IT projects that meet the statutory criteria for IT Project Oversight under s. 282.0051, F.S., must comply with Rule 60GG-1.003, F.A.C.

Enterprise Agencies that are unsure if Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C., applies to a particular initiative should contact FLDS for assistance in determining the applicable requirements.

2. Can Enterprise Agencies tailor project management documentation for smaller or low-Risk projects?

Project management documentation can be scaled based on project size, budget, Scope, complexity, methodology, and Risk, provided the Enterprise Agency continues to meet applicable Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C. requirements.

3. What are the required documents that Enterprise Agencies must maintain for projects?

Enterprise Agencies must maintain the documentation required by Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C. The specific documentation will vary based on project size, Scope, complexity, methodology, and applicable rule requirements.

4. How is Total Project Cost defined?

Total Project Cost is the estimated cost of the entire IT Project from initiation through closing, not just the current phase, contract, fiscal year, or appropriation. Total Project Cost includes all anticipated expenditures and financial obligations needed to deliver the project.

The estimated Total Project Cost is used to determine whether a project meets the statutory threshold for Project Oversight under s. 282.0051, F.S. Oversight is triggered when the project's estimated total cost exceeds the statutory threshold, even if the project has not received all funding or costs will be incurred over multiple fiscal years.

For example, if an Enterprise Agency plans to implement a new system over three years with an estimated total cost of $25 million, the project's total cost is $25 million, not just the amount appropriated or expected to be spent during the first year. The project is subject to oversight because the Total Project Cost exceeds the statutory threshold.

FLDS Oversight and Governance

5. Which Enterprise Agency meetings should include FLDS?

Enterprise Agencies should invite FLDS to attend project status and governance meetings where project progress, changes, Risks, action items, Issues, decisions, and lessons learned (CRAIDL or RAID) are discussed.

Examples include:

- Status meetings: daily standups, weekly or biweekly meetings, monthly status meetings, etc.
- Independent Verification and Validation (IV&V) meetings: weekly, monthly, and quarterly
- Executive steering committee or project leadership team meetings
- CRAIDL or RAID meetings, change control boards, or any other meetings to discuss changes, Risks, action items, Issues, decisions, and lessons learned
- Continuing oversight meetings pursuant to s. 287.057(26), F.S.

The FLDS oversight team attends as silent observers and does not participate in technical or development meetings. However, technical advisement is available on request.

6. How does FLDS assess the Enterprise Agencies' project level of Risk?

FLDS assesses project Risk using information provided by the Enterprise Agency, including required project management documentation, status reporting, Risk and Issue information, governance activities, project performance metrics, and other oversight processes established under Rule 60GG-1.003, F.A.C. Additionally, FLDS considers internal oversight metrics and Risk indicators when evaluating overall project health.

7. When does FLDS consider oversight complete for a project?

FLDS considers project oversight complete after reviewing and accepting the final closing package.

Operations and Maintenance

8. What are the requirements for O&M projects falling below the thresholds identified in subsection (6) of Rule 60GG-1.002, F.A.C.?

Projects that fall below the thresholds identified in Rule 60GG-1.002, F.A.C. are not subject to subsections (2) through (5) of Rule 60GG-1.002, F.A.C. Instead, Enterprise Agencies must create and maintain an O&M Plan and manage the project in accordance with that plan.

An O&M project must comply with the requirements of Rule 60GG-1.002(2) through (5), F.A.C., if the project exceeds any one of the thresholds identified in Rule 60GG-1.002(6), F.A.C.

Plan of Action and Milestones

9. What are the requirements for O&M projects falling below the thresholds identified in subsection (6) of Rule 60GG-1.002, F.A.C.?

In accordance with Rule 60GG-1.004, F.A.C., Enterprise Agencies should document compliance challenges, associated Risks, and remediation activities through a Plan of Action and Milestones (POA&M) and coordinate with FLDS as appropriate. A template for a POA&M is available on the FLDS website and can be submitted through the Project Oversight Portal on the FLDS Gateway.

10. If an Enterprise Agency has submitted a POA&M, how will the agency know when they are determined to be in compliance with the rules?

Submission of a POA&M does not mean an IT Project is compliant with Rule 60GG-1, F.A.C. Rather, the POA&M documents how an Enterprise Agency will achieve compliance when immediate compliance is not feasible because of operational challenges or significant project Risks.

FLDS will work collaboratively with the Enterprise Agency throughout the POA&M process to monitor progress, provide guidance, and verify that the identified corrective actions have been completed. An IT Project is considered compliant when the outstanding deficiencies identified in the POA&M have been satisfactorily addressed. Until that time, the project remains subject to the POA&M process and will continue to be identified as having an active POA&M in FLDS's quarterly reporting.

Resources and Support

11. Will FLDS provide new and updated templates that align with the new rule?

FLDS will update templates and continue to provide new templates to align with the Rule Chapter 60GG-1, F.A.C. requirements.

12. When should an Enterprise Agency or project team submit a Legislative Budget Request to FLDS for review?

Enterprise Agencies should submit Legislative Budget Requests to allow adequate time for FLDS review and feedback before submission to the Office of Policy and Budget.

13. What is the process for contacting the Project Management and Oversight Office with questions?

Enterprise Agencies can contact the FLDS Project Management and Oversight Office at PMO@digital.fl.gov.